

Day 1 — Five Friends Story

Module: Panchabhūta (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Children meet the five elements through a story and a touch-station, and can name at least three by end of class.

Materials

- 5 sample objects: rock, water in a clear jar, candle (unlit), balloon, empty box
- Drawing paper + crayons

The flow

Settle + chant (5 min)

Sit on the mat. Teacher: “*We’re starting something new. For the next two weeks we’ll meet **five friends**.*”

Teach the chant (3 times: soft / normal / loud, clap on each name):

pr̥thvī, ap, tejas, vāyu, ākāśa Earth, water, fire, air, space!

Story (10 min)

The Five Friends

Once there were five friends. Each one was made of something different.

The first friend was **Pr̥thvī**. She was made of **earth**. She was solid and steady. You could stand on her, build a house on her, plant a seed in her. (Hold up the rock.)

The second friend was **Ap**. He was made of **water**. He flowed and changed shape. He could fill any cup, any bottle, any pond. (Hold up the water jar.)

The third friend was **Tejas**. He was made of **fire**. He gave warmth and light. The sun is his big brother. (Hold up the candle — “*this would be Tejas if we lit it*”.)

The fourth friend was **Vāyu**. She was made of **air**. She moved invisibly. When she ran past you, you felt a breeze. (Hold up the balloon.)

The fifth friend was **Ākāśa**. She was made of **space**. She didn’t have a shape or colour. She was where all the other friends lived. (Hold up the empty box — “*look — Ākāśa is INSIDE the box, where there’s nothing.*”)

All five friends were everywhere — in this room, in your home, even inside your body. Today we’ll go meet them.

Touch + see (10 min)

Set the 5 objects out. Children go in pairs to each object, look and touch (where safe), and chorus the name as they touch.

Draw (8 min)

Each child draws ONE element (their favourite) on paper. Write the Sanskrit name at the top (teacher helps spell).

Show + chant (2 min)

3 children hold up their drawings. Class chants the name of that element.

End with the daily chant once.

Homework / take-home

- At home tonight: find ONE thing for each of the five elements. Bring one of them to class tomorrow (small enough to fit in your pocket or a small bag).

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Draw all five elements on one page.
- **Tier down:** Just remember three names — *prthvī*, *ap*, *vāyu*. The other two can come later this week.

Teacher's quick notes

- Sing the chant slowly the first time. Speed up over the week.
- Some children will laugh at “Ākāśa is empty space.” That’s fine. The laugh helps it stick.